

He showed me a version of his machine called the Difference Engine. It was designed to stop people getting math calculations wrong.

Q: Is it right that Charles has given you a nickname?

A: Yes! Charles calls me the “Enchantress of Numbers” and he is called the “Father of Computing.”

Q: Tell us about the machine that you worked on with Charles.

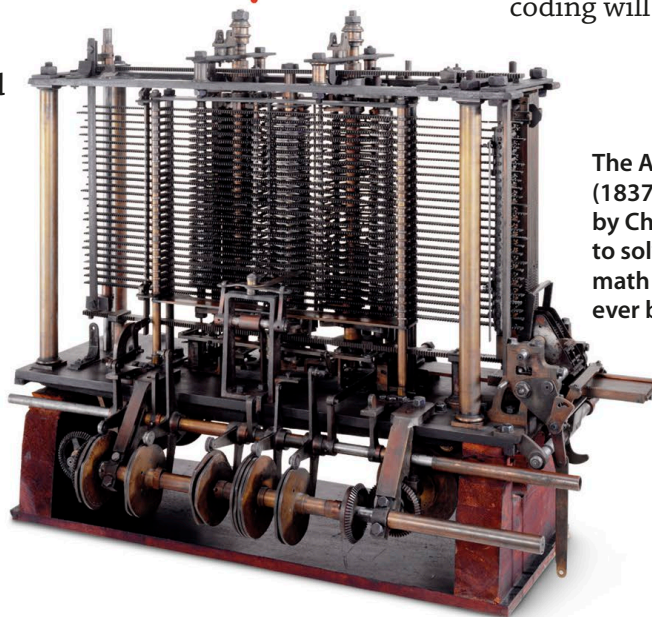
A: The Analytical Engine was the second machine designed by Charles, and it was fascinating! Charles gave me the designs for the machine. I realized that it could use codes made up of letters, symbols, and numbers to solve problems. It was the first computer that could be programmed.

Q: When did you actually write your computer program?

A: In 1842, I wrote a set of instructions and showed they could be used by the computer to solve a mathematics problem. A science journal in England published my findings.

Q: So you are the first computer programmer?

A: Well, yes, but I don't like to brag! What excites me most is this machine's potential. It is more than a calculator. The possibilities are endless! I believe all types of different things can be converted into computer code. Who knows what the future of computer coding will bring!



The Analytical Engine (1837) was designed by Charles Babbage to solve more complex math calculations than ever before.

Visionary
Ada Lovelace believed computers could one day be used to create music or art.

Modern-day laptop computer

